

This base theory is what sets A.L.I.C.E. apart from all other conversational agents. The assumption that every cognitive scientist makes is that for a truly successful conversation agent, it would require the system to have a vast knowledge of a language and its nuances. Wallace, however, believes that normal conversation doesn't have nuances and prefers to reduce and simplify natural language processing rather than expand and complicate it. Given this approach, it's difficult to say whether A.L.I.C.E. is an intelligent agent or not. At best, it would be a weak AI.

Unlike most of ELIZA's successors, A.L.I.C.E. is based on a completely new computer programming language called AIML (Artificial Intelligence Markup Language).

## Jabberwacky and Cleverbot

For the past few years, British programmer Rollo Carpenter has been working on a chatterbot that has gotten him awards and accolades aplenty. Called Jabberwacky, it has been designed to pass the Turing Test – and along with winning the Loebner prize, it is now the most advanced model of imitated human chat around.

“George”, a character within Jabberwacky also won the Loebner Prize (in 2005) for being “the most human”. To web surfers, George is a bald,



George, the virtual avatar of the Jabberwacky chat bot